Microsoft Power Platform

The Copilot Compass

Finding True North Across Copilot, Cowork, Scout, and Agents

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“The biggest mistake with AI isn’t using the wrong app. It’s using one mode for every job.”

Me, after watching one too many people use chat for everything and being frustrated

Let’s address the elephant in the room

Microsoft Copilot	Microsoft 365 Copilot	Copilot Chat	Copilot Studio
Agent Builder	Copilot Cowork	Researcher	Analyst
Work IQ	Agent 365	Copilot Home	Copilot Code
Scout	Autopilot	Windows Autopilot (not that one)	GitHub Copilot

Every one of these is a real product name. As of this morning.

~~Scout~~

→

Autopilot

Renamed September 25, 2026. About a month after I submitted this session.

Names change. The job each tool does doesn’t. That’s what we’ll navigate by.

Six months. Four reinventions.



APR 2026

Apps do the work

Agent mode goes GA in Word, Excel, and PowerPoint. Copilot stops suggesting and starts editing.





JUN 2026

Delegation arrives

Cowork goes GA. Scout shows up as a desktop preview.





JUL 2026

Smarter everywhere

New models land. PowerPoint builds decks from your meetings and files.





SEP 2026

The new Copilot

Home, Code, and Autopilot in one app. Scout becomes Autopilot.

If you tried Copilot a year ago, you haven't tried this Copilot.

Wait, isn’t it one app now?

> **“This quarter, we are bringing these Copilot experiences together, including code, in one super app.”**
>
> Satya Nadella, FY26 Q4 earnings call, July 29, 2026

THE NEW COPILOT, SEPT 25, 2026

Home. Code. Autopilot.

ASK
Chat
Seat license

DELEGATE
Cowork
Copilot Credits

BUILD
Code, Agent Builder, Studio
Varies

AUTOMATE
Autopilot
Copilot Credits

One front door. Four directions. Two meters.

Your seat license covers Chat. Copilot Credits cover Cowork, Code, and Autopilot.

Hi, I'm April

Principal Cloud Advocate at Microsoft

Author of The Copilot Compass

Yes, same name. Not a coincidence ☺

55K✦ builders on YouTube

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Co-founder of Agent Academy

aka.ms/agent-academy

Oklahomie and Musician

Based in Tulsa. Check out "Songbird" by Shadow of a Siren on Spotify, Apple Music



Hi, I'm Bryan

Principal Customer Experience PM

M365 MVP Group Lead

https://mvp.microsoft.com

Content Lead Microsoft conferences

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Based in Charlotte, NC

Pinball, 80s , and Travel fanatic



Agenda

- Why one front door still needs a compass
- The Copilot Compass framework
- One real journey, four directions, a demo at every stop
- Patterns, pitfalls, and where to start Monday

The one-mode trap

Chat as a project manager

A two-day project through one chat window, then copy-pasting across forty prompts.

Cowork prices for Chat questions

Sending a quick question to a metered mode because it was the tab you had open.

Agents for everything

Building a full agent for a question you'll ask exactly once.

AI only when you remember

Nothing happens unless you type. The work that needs watching goes unwatched.

It's not an app problem. It's a navigation problem.

Every direction has a different job

SHARPEN

Chat

Your whiteboard partner. Reason, draft, and research with you in the loop.

Included in your seat

MONITOR

Autopilot

Your full-time hire. An ongoing job with no finish line, watched while you're not.

Copilot Credits

DELEGATE

Cowork

Your contractor with a work order. A defined deliverable, handed back finished.

Copilot Credits

SCALE

Code, Agent Builder, Copilot Studio

Your playbook. Tools and agents so the whole team works the same way.

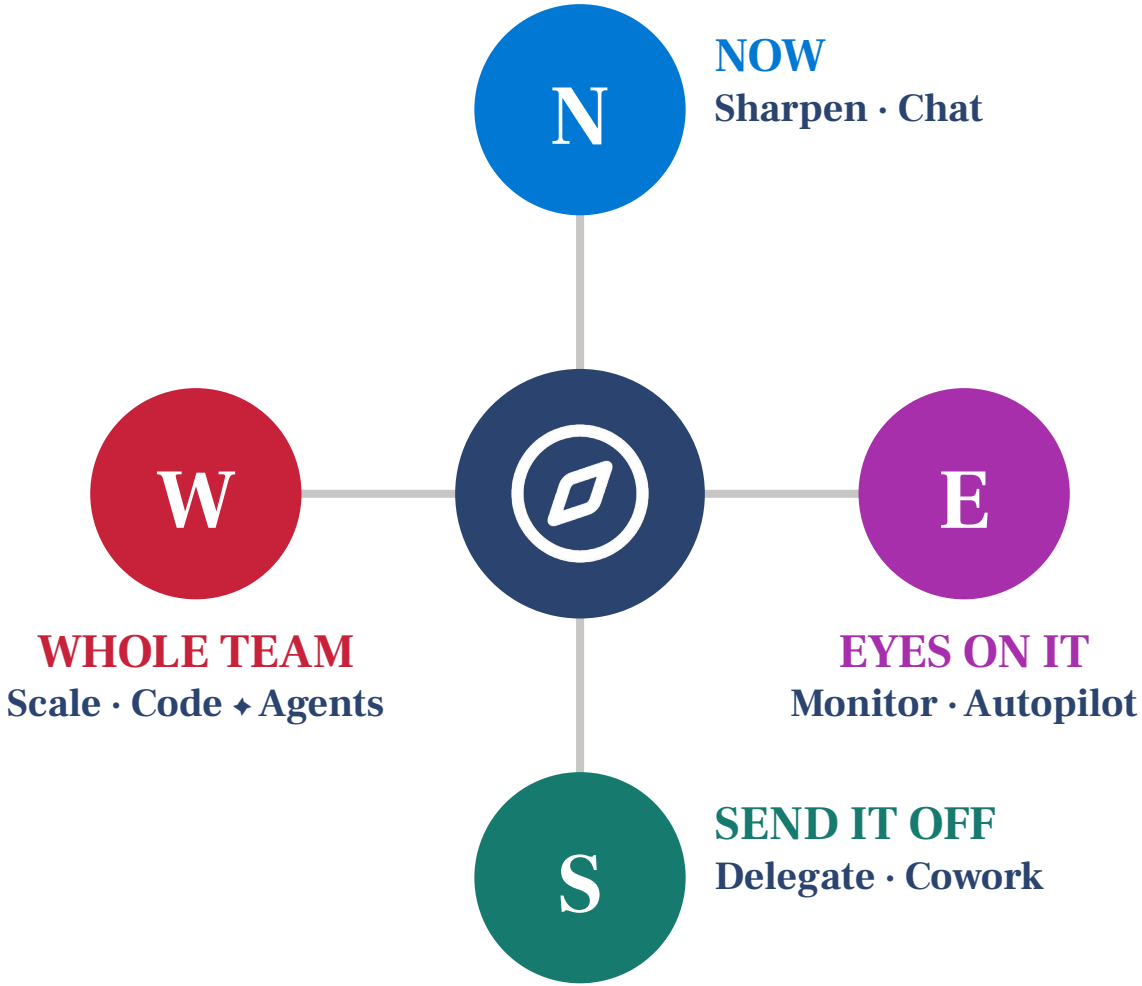
Depends on the builder

Chat to sharpen. Autopilot to monitor. Cowork to delegate. Agents to scale.

Introducing the Copilot Compass

Four directions. One compass.

The Copilot app is the housing. You still point the needle.



Let the letter ask the question

N — Now
Sharpen with Chat

E — Eyes on it
Monitor with Autopilot

S — Send it off
Delegate to Cowork

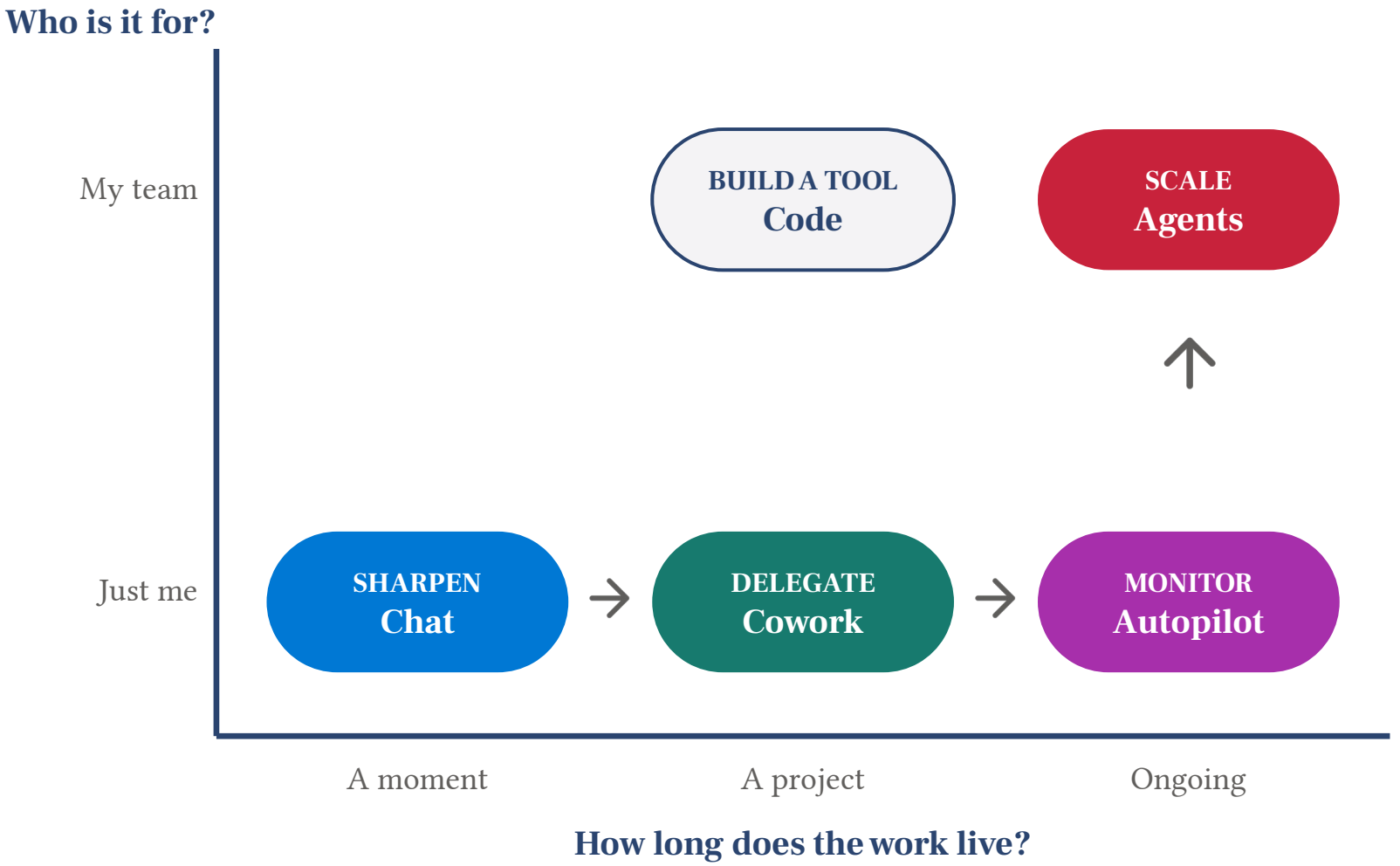
W — Whole team
Scale with Code and agents

What’s the finish line?

My next thought. I’m still figuring it out.	NORTH | SHARPEN Chat
There isn’t one. It’s an ongoing responsibility.	EAST | MONITOR Autopilot
A deliverable I can review and accept.	SOUTH | DELEGATE Cowork
Everyone doing it the same way, every time.	WEST | SCALE Code ✦ Agents

Even when Copilot starts routing for you, you still own this question.

Or read the map



Moving right?

Delegate more. Let it run without you.

Moving up?

Package it so the team gets it too.

Let’s follow one real journey

Maya Chen

Director of Customer Success, TechFlow Solutions

Q4 renewals are slipping. Leadership wants a plan by Friday.

She has 40 CSMs and zero spare hours.

IDEA

Why are renewals slipping?

Chat

ACTION

Build the rescue plan and do the busywork

Cowork

WATCH

Who goes quiet next?

Autopilot

IMPACT

Give every CSM the playbook

Agents

NORTH | DIRECTION 1 OF 4

Sharpen with Chat

Chat | Sharpen

Your thinking partner in Home, and right inside Word, Excel, and PowerPoint.

Reach for it when

- Making sense of a messy thread, meeting, or doc
- Going deep with Researcher and Analyst
- @mentioning the Word, Excel, or PowerPoint agent for a real file

Skip it when

- The “chat” is really a two-day project



Chat: GA, in your seat | New Home layout: Frontier

Demo | Why are renewals slipping?

NORTH | SHARPEN | Chat

Maya pressure-tests a hunch across her email, meetings, and CRM notes, then asks Chat to argue against it.

This isn’t the Copilot you tried last year

WHAT YOU REMEMBER	WHAT IT DOES NOW
It suggested. You did the work.	It makes the changes for you and shows every step
Excel: here’s a formula to try	Excel plans first, then builds the tables, PivotTables, and charts
PowerPoint: generic slides from one prompt	PowerPoint builds from your meetings and files, on your brand template
Word: rewrite the paragraph you selected	Word revises the whole doc toward a goal, with Track Changes on
One model, take it or leave it	Pick your model, including the latest from OpenAI and Anthropic

Demo | The apps got smarter

NORTH | SHARPEN | Word, Excel, PowerPoint

Maya's hypothesis becomes a planned-out Excel analysis and a leadership deck built from yesterday's Teams meeting.

SOUTH | DIRECTION 2 OF 4

Delegate to Cowork

Cowork | Delegate

Delegate the outcome. It plans, works across apps, and hands back finished files.

Reach for it when

- The job has a finish line you can review
- You want a deliverable, not a draft
- It should run on a schedule, or when an email lands

Skip it when

- A quick question would do (head north)

GA since June | Metered in Copilot Credits



Demo | Build the rescue kit

SOUTH | DELEGATE | Cowork

One prompt becomes a tracker, outreach drafts, check-in invites, and an on-brand leadership deck.

EAST | DIRECTION 3 OF 4

Monitor with Autopilot (formerly Scout)

Autopilot | Monitor

Formerly Scout, rebuilt for the cloud. A teammate with its own identity that works while you don't.

Reach for it when

- The job is ongoing, with no finish line
- You want stalled threads flagged early
- Follow-ups shouldn't depend on your memory

Skip it when

- You haven't decided what it may do alone



Private preview | Broad rollout by year end

So what happened to Scout?

THE SCOUT DESKTOP APP	AUTOPILOT
Lived on your PC or Mac	Lives in the cloud, inside your tenant, around the clock
You chatted with it in its own app	You @mention it in Teams and Outlook, like a colleague
Reached your local files, browser, and shell	Has its own identity, memory, and workspace
Billed through GitHub Copilot	Billed in Copilot Credits
Maintenance mode since Sept 30. No new features.	Private preview now. Broad availability targeted by year end.

Demo | Who’s going quiet?

EAST | MONITOR | Cowork trigger today, Autopilot next

Maya sets a Cowork task that fires when the renewals channel lights up, then meets the Autopilot that will own the job.

WEST | DIRECTION 4 OF 4

Scale with Code and agents

The build ladder

Package what you know so it works for everyone, the same way, every time.

Code

BUILD A TOOL

- Apps, trackers, dashboards, and desktop widgets from plain language
- Publish to your team on Managed Runtime (preview)
- Third tab in the new Copilot app

Frontier | Copilot Credits

Agent Builder

PROVE IT

- Built inside Copilot, in minutes
- Instructions and knowledge in plain language
- Needs actions? Copy it to Studio

Included with Copilot

Copilot Studio

RUN IT

- Tools, flows, connectors, and MCP
- Autonomous triggers and multi-agent
- GitHub Copilot harness meter starts when you build

GA | Pick your harness

Code to build a tool. Agent Builder to prove it. Copilot Studio to run it.

Code | Build a tool

Describe the tool you wish you had. Code writes it, runs it, and shows you a live preview.

Reach for it when

- You keep rebuilding the same spreadsheet view
- Your team needs a tracker, form, or dashboard
- A quick script or scheduled job would save an hour

Skip it when

- You need a governed business app (hello, Power Apps)

Frontier | Metered in Copilot Credits



Demo | Build Maya a tool

WEST | SCALE | Code

Maya turns a CRM export into a renewal-risk tracker her CSMs can update, then publishes it to the team.

When to graduate to Copilot Studio

Agent Builder



Copilot Studio

Copy to Copilot Studio is built in. Prove it first, then graduate it.

It needs to do things, not just know things

Connectors, flows, APIs, and MCP tools

It should run without being asked

Triggers, autonomy, and scheduled work

You need real lifecycle

Versions, staged deployments, and analytics

It’s going beyond your team

Teams store, more channels, and wider governance

Demo | Prove it, then run it

WEST | SCALE | Agent Builder to Copilot Studio

Maya proves a Renewal Coach in Agent Builder, then copies it to Copilot Studio to give it real actions.

One journey, four directions



SHARPEN

Chat

A tested hypothesis, plus an Excel analysis and a deck from her meeting

DELEGATE

Cowork

Tracker, outreach drafts, invites, and a leadership deck

MONITOR

Autopilot

Accounts watched every day, flagged before anyone asks

SCALE

Agents

A tracker built in Code, and a Renewal Coach running in Copilot Studio

Same app. Four directions. The magic is in the handoffs.

Four handoffs worth stealing

SHARPEN → DELEGATE

When the chat turns into a to-do list, hand it to Cowork.

MONITOR → DELEGATE

Autopilot spots it. Cowork handles it. You approve it.

DELEGATE → SCALE

Done it three times? It’s an agent now.

SCALE → DELEGATE

A Copilot Studio workflow can kick off a Cowork task. (Preview)



The rule of three

Done it three times by hand? Make it an agent.
Haven’t? Don’t build it yet.

Four moves most people miss

REF DECK → POWERPOINT

Restyle any deck to match one you already love.

POWER BI → EXCEL

Analyze governed Power BI data right in the grid.

COPILOT → WORD

Copilot edits with Track Changes on. You approve every line.

COWORK → APP

Type /app in Cowork and get a working app. (Frontier)

Five pitfalls I see every week

THE PITFALL	THE FIX
The Swiss Army chatbot	Multi-step jobs go to Cowork, not a 40-message chat
Credits on autopilot	Set spend policies and caps before you turn on metered modes
Human copy-paste middleware	Design handoffs between tools, not through your clipboard
Autopilot with no guardrails	Decide up front what runs alone and what needs approval
Rolling out tools, not workflows	Train on the journey of work, not product tours

Where to start



Executives

Start SOUTH

Schedule a Cowork brief on your priorities. Line up Autopilot for when it lands.



Makers

Start WEST

Prove it in Agent Builder, build tools in Code, graduate to Studio.



IT pros

Start with guardrails

Set spend policies. E7 includes the seat, not the credits.



Knowledge workers

Start NORTH

Get fluent in Chat, then hand one real task to Cowork this week.

Take this home

1

One front door, four directions

The app is one. The jobs aren't. Learn the jobs.

2

What's the finish line? The answer picks the mode, and the meter.

Sharpen, monitor, delegate, or scale? The answer picks the mode, and the meter.

3

Design the handoffs

That's where isolated AI moments become real productivity.

YOUR HOMEWORK

Pick one real workflow and walk it around the compass this week.

Keep exploring



The Copilot Compass, the book

thecopilotcompass.com



Agent Academy, free hands-on agent training

aka.ms/agent-academy



Get started with Copilot Cowork

learn.microsoft.com/microsoft-365/copilot/cowork/get-started



Agent Builder or Copilot Studio? Microsoft's guide

learn.microsoft.com/microsoft-365/copilot/extensibility/copilot-studio-experience



Copilot Studio documentation

learn.microsoft.com/microsoft-copilot-studio



Demos and walkthroughs

youtube.com/@AprilDunnam

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Thank you! Questions?

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